

RESEARCH AUDIT

Brand audited: Ryze Mushroom Coffee

This is what a strong submission looks like. It is not perfect, and it is not meant to be. Notice how much of it is disagreement.

Six things were edited or rejected. One claim could not be traced at all. The student disagreed with the AI twice, including on the white space call. That is the work.

BEFORE YOU RUN

BRAND	MARKET	DEPTH	TOOL USED
Ryze Mushroom Coffee	United States	BETTER	Claude, web search on

WHAT I EXPECT THE MAIN OBJECTION TO BE

Price. It is a premium product replacing something people already buy cheaply.

WHAT I EXPECT THE MAIN DESIRE TO BE

More energy without the crash.

- X** I removed names, emails, numbers and order IDs from anything I uploaded.
- X** I am allowed to use this client data, or I uploaded none. Public research only, no client data uploaded.

SOURCES

Which sources did the AI say it checked but clearly did not, or could not?

It marked YouTube as checked but only listed video titles. No comment text anywhere, so it read the videos, not the audience.

It marked social as checked using only Ryze own posts. No audience comments. Reddit was real though, six threads with actual comment text.

Who is overrepresented in this evidence? Complainers, fans, or one platform?

Complainers. BBB and ComplaintsBoard only hold complaints, so billing looks larger than it may be. The Target review form asks about flavour, which inflates taste.

One question this evidence CANNOT answer, no matter how good it looks

How many customers actually cancel because of billing rather than the product. That needs the client subscription data, not reviews.

VERDICT

☐ Good enough to work with.

☒ **Sent it back. What I asked for:**

Actual YouTube comment text, and three-star reviews specifically, since those carry the trade-offs.

PATTERNS

AI PATTERN	PEOPLE	SITES	YOUR VERDICT
Taste is the main objection	14	5	EDIT. Split into three, see below.
Subscription and cancellation friction	13	6	ACCEPT. Independent across six sites.
Some people felt no effect	5	4	FLAG. Real pattern, cause unknown.

One change I made: merged, split, renamed or rejected. Which, and why.

Split the taste pattern into three. The AI put earthy, muddy, sediment, needs creamer, smooth when stirred, and better than expected into one bucket.

Those are three different positions: it tastes bad, it improves when prepared a certain way, and it beat low expectations. Different problems, different fixes.

One piece of evidence I found that DISAGREES with the AI main finding

The AI concluded taste is the biggest barrier. But several reviewers said they disliked the taste and kept buying anyway.

So taste may be a satisfaction problem, not a purchase barrier. Those are not the same thing.

CAN YOU TRACE IT?

THE CLAIM	THE EXACT WORDS BEHIND IT	SOURCE	VERDICT
Ryze customers are price-sensitive	Three separate mentions of cost. Nobody said they left over price.	Reddit x2, Trustpilot x1	EDIT. Price is mentioned. Sensitivity is not shown.
Ryze contains MCT oil	Appears in marketing copy. Not in the current ingredient list I checked.	Ryze product pages	FLAG. Contradiction, needs verifying with the brand.
The founder story ad is their best performer	None. I could not find any evidence behind this.	None	REJECT. Ad Library shows it is running, not that it wins.

How many of the three could NOT be traced to a real source?

One out of three.

What did you do about them?

Rejected the ad performance claim and rewrote it as an Observed line: the founder ad has been running since at least the date I checked.

Kept MCT oil as a flagged contradiction rather than deleting it, since the contradiction itself is a finding.

COACH NOTE

A real submission carries the live URL for every source. Platform names are shown here for readability.

JUDGMENT

THE MARKET

THE DESIRE, IN YOUR WORDS: WHAT THEY WANT TO KEEP

The morning ritual, the alertness, the focus. They are not trying to quit coffee.

THE DESIRE, IN YOUR WORDS: WHAT THEY WANT TO LOSE

The jitters, the anxiety, the afternoon crash, the sour stomach. The price they pay for the energy.

AI STAGE	DO YOU AGREE?	WHY, OR WHY NOT
Stage 4	Partly	Five of six competitors use a version of no jitters and four claim number one, so Stage 4 fits the DTC buyer. But Target reviewers still ask what mushroom coffee even is, which reads earlier. Likely different stages by channel.

ONE WHITE SPACE

THE IDEA	DO CUSTOMERS WANT IT?	IS ANYONE SAYING IT?	CAN THE BRAND BACK IT?	TIER
Publish exact mushroom dosages and third-party testing	Weak. Only two people asked for it.	Few competitors publish per-ingredient amounts.	Yes. Dosage is already shown on two products.	NOT PROVEN YET

The AI called this Tier 1, use it now. I moved it down. Two people asking is not demand, and the competitor gap alone does not make it one.

WHAT YOU STILL DO NOT KNOW

WHAT WE DO NOT KNOW	WHAT TO COLLECT NEXT	WHERE TO GET IT
How many people cancel over billing versus the product	Cancellation reasons and checkout abandonment	Client subscription platform
Whether preparation actually changes taste satisfaction	A direct question to recent buyers	Post-purchase survey
Whether the no-effect group differs from responders	Dose, duration used, and expectation at purchase	Customer interviews

SIGN OFF

HOW MANY THINGS DID YOU EDIT OR REJECT IN TOTAL?

Six. Three edits, one reject, two flags.

LOOK BACK AT PAGE 1. WHAT DID YOU EXPECT, AND WHAT ACTUALLY TURNED UP?

I expected price to be the main objection. Price came up, but subscription control and taste came up more often and across more sites.

The thing I did not expect: people who liked the product and left anyway because of billing. That is a business problem wearing a marketing costume.

- ☒ Every claim I kept can be traced to a source I can point to.
- ☒ I counted people, not quotes.
- ☒ There is counter-evidence in here.
- ☒ Every inference is labelled as an inference, not stated as fact.
- ☒ I did not call any ad a winner.

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WHY THIS ONE PASSES

IT DISAGREES.

Six edits or rejects, including two disagreements with the AI judgment rather than just its facts.

IT CAUGHT AN INVENTED CLAIM.

The founder ad performance claim had nothing behind it, and the student rejected it instead of repeating it in a client meeting.

IT KEPT THE INCONVENIENT EVIDENCE.

People who disliked the taste and repurchased anyway weaken the AI headline finding, and it stayed in.

IT DOWNGRADED A NICE-SOUNDING IDEA.

Two people asking for dosage transparency is not demand. Moving it from Tier 1 to Not Proven Yet is the whole discipline in one decision.

IT KNOWS WHAT IT CANNOT SAY.

Every gap points at a specific thing to collect and a specific place to get it.

WHAT WOULD FAIL

A worksheet full of ACCEPTs, a traceability check where all three claims happened to be easy ones, or a submission with no counter-evidence anywhere.